

RELAY

Product Requirements Document

AI Memory Layer for Founder-Led Sales

March 2026 | Confidential

Status	Version	Audience	Stage
Product Research Complete. Ready for Engineering Planning.	March 2026	Leadership, Product, Design, Engineering	0-20 person early-stage startups

Executive Summary

The Context: In most early-stage startups, the first sales engine is not a team—it is the founder. Until a company reaches roughly \$1M to \$5M in ARR, the founder is the one driving deals forward: replying to prospects, taking calls, following up, and keeping relationships warm. However, sales are only one fraction of their day. Because the same person is constantly context-switching across product, hiring, operations, and fundraising, time is their absolute scarcest resource. In this reality, traditional CRM logging becomes a broken mechanic: a task demanding immediate manual effort for a delayed, probabilistic payoff.

The Solution: Relay is a memory and action layer purpose-built for founder-led sales. It sits entirely on top of the tools the founder already uses, passively captures valuable deal context from work that is already happening, and proactively tells the founder exactly what needs attention next.

The Key Bet: If Relay removes the behavioral tax of manual logging while still creating highly trusted deal context, founders will follow up more consistently, maintain a healthier pipeline, and seamlessly hand off relationship history when their first sales hire joins.

The Core Mechanics: Relay operates as an ambient intelligence layer, capturing deal context from conversations the founder is already having. It delivers three distinct outputs with **zero manual input** required from the founder:

Output	What It Does
A. Auto-records	Structured deal records populated from email, calendar, and existing tracker signals. No input required.
B. Proactive nudges	Morning digest: "Follow up with Priya today; she went quiet after the pricing call." Urgency-ranked.
C. On-demand retrieval	"What did I last discuss with Rahul at Acme?" returns meaning and context, not a list of documents.

Design mandate: Build a system where the deal record fills itself automatically, so the founder's only job is to sell.

01. The Problem

Every CRM ever built assumes a dedicated person updates the system after a conversation. In a 0-20 person startup, that person is the founder -- simultaneously managing product, hiring, investors, and 50-150 active sales conversations across 4-6 channels.

The logging step is architecturally incompatible with how founder-led sales actually works.

Current User Journey: What Founders Do Today

Before Relay, a founder manages sales across a fragmented stack with no single source of truth.

WHERE THE CHAIN BREAKS

From **Live Conversation** to **Broken Record**



LIVE CONVERSATION

WhatsApp · LinkedIn DM · Zoom Call · Phone



MEMORY STARTS FADING

Founder moves to next call, next deal, next fire



⚡ BREAK #1 — THE FORGETTING POINT



FOUNDER DECIDES TO LOG

Or doesn't. At 80+ deals, mostly doesn't.



⚡ BREAK #2 — THE COMPRESSION POINT



MANUAL ENTRY

38 minutes of conversation → 6 words typed



⚡ BREAK #3 — THE DISTORTION POINT



CRM RECORD CREATED

Fields filled. Stage set. Optimistically.



⚡ BREAK #4 — THE COMPOUNDING FAILURE



DECISIONS MADE FROM THIS DATA

Forecasts · Investor updates · First hire handoffs



ROOT CAUSE

CRM sits *after* the conversation. By the time a founder opens it, the real intelligence — tone, commitment, intent — is already gone. Every record is a reconstruction, not a capture.

● Reality ● Decay begins ● Risk zone ● Broken ● Compounding

Stage	What the Founder Does	What Goes Wrong
Prospect reaches out	Replies on WhatsApp, LinkedIn DM, or email depending on channel	CRM sees nothing. Warmest conversations are invisible.
Call or demo happens	Joins Zoom or takes a phone call	No record created. Context lives in memory.
After the call	"I'll log this tonight." Opens Notion or Sheets instead. Compresses 38 min of signal to 6 words.	Context lost. Stage set optimistically. Follow-up intent not committed.
Days pass	Context-switches across 8-12 roles. CRM logging deprioritised continuously.	60-80% of warm leads receive no structured follow-up. [Lusha 2025; Growth List 2025]
First hire joins	Briefs new hire verbally for 2 weeks. Nothing in the CRM.	91% of first hires miss quota. 68% leave within 18 months. [Haus Advisors; OpenView]

Research Foundation

Discovery based on: two founder interviews, 600+ competitor reviews across Attio, Folk, Breakcold, and Pipedrive, Reddit and Hacker News founder communities, and secondary industry research.

Who	Company	Key Insight
Jad Taha	Sales Coaching, solo founder, software background	Tool-literate founder defaulted to Google Sheets over a dedicated CRM. Hired a part-time employee purely for data hygiene. Adoption failure is a product design problem, not a skills gap.
Dhawal Phadke	Sattviko / FoodYoga, FMCG/CPG, 10-15 people	Used Agile CRM for 1-3 years then abandoned it. Independently proposed voice-based post-call entry -- the same solution Relay's design team arrived at separately.
SVP Solutions	B2B Fintech, Series D, enterprise sales	"The objects in existing CRMs are not wrong. But the way humans are asked to populate them is." Gong is becoming a CRM by owning the conversation layer -- proof that owning the data channel is the winning playbook.

Evidence Table

Problem	Finding	Source
Follow-up gap	60-80% of warm leads never receive structured follow-up	Lusha 2025; Growth List 2025
Manual entry burden	32% of reps spend >1 hr/day on manual CRM entry	Breakcold 2025

Problem	Finding	Source
Dropout rate	92% of salespeople stop trying after 4 contact attempts	Growth List 2025
First hire failure	91% of first sales hires miss quota; 68% leave within 18 months	Haus Advisors; OpenView
Channel blindness	CRM captures email only. WhatsApp and LinkedIn are invisible.	Field interview, SVP B2B Fintech Series D
Stage decay	Deals marked "Proposal Sent" stay there for 3+ months, then close as lost	Field interview, SVP B2B Fintech Series D
Workaround prevalence	73% of startups lack documented sales process; founders build Notion systems	Haus Advisors; Founder Persona [persona_founder.md]

Why Every Existing Tool Fails

600+ negative reviews reveal the same six failures regardless of how modern or lightweight the tool claims to be.

Failure	What Founders Say	Why It Has Not Been Fixed
WhatsApp is invisible	"The CRM knows nothing about my warmest conversations"	Personal WhatsApp has no API. E2E encrypted by design. A deliberate Meta platform decision.
No real mobile app	"I close deals on my phone. The CRM requires a laptop."	Folk, Attio, Breakcold all lack proper mobile apps.
Manual entry never hits zero	"It reduces entry at first, then reintroduces it at scale"	Every tool breaks past 50 deals when logging volume exceeds what any founder can sustain.
Phone calls are invisible	"My most important calls are nowhere in the system"	Mobile calls go through carrier networks. No app-level API exists.
Pricing punishes growth	"Fair when small. Punishing when it starts working."	Every tool prices against scale -- more usage, more cost, without a corresponding value increase.

Competitor Analysis

Tool	Core Problem for Founders	Setup Cost	Effectiveness for Small Teams
HubSpot Free	Still demands manual logging. 200+ features, founders need ~8.	Hours to days	Low. Feature bloat creates cognitive overhead. Built for marketing orgs.

Tool	Core Problem for Founders	Setup Cost	Effectiveness for Small Teams
Pipedrive	Pipeline-first -- assumes a defined sales process exists. Most founders lack one.	Days	Medium. Cleaner UI. But founders still must log everything manually.
Attio / Folk / Clay	Relationship intelligence, not an action layer. No follow-up engine. No write-back.	Hours	Low for solo founders. No proactive surfacing. Read-only.
Salesforce / Zoho	"If you need a consultant to set it up, it's too complex." [adiint]	2-3 months	Very low for 0-5 person teams. 20-70% of implementations fail. [Enable Services 2025]
Gong	Owns calls only. Becoming a CRM from the call-data direction.	Moderate	Proof that owning the channel is the winning playbook. Relay starts with email and calendar.

Cross competitor synthesis

Four tools. Hundreds of negative reviews. The same six failures emerge across all of them. These are not isolated product bugs but they are structural gaps that the entire CRM category has failed to close.

Failure Mode	Folk	Attio	Breakcold	Pipedrive
No personal WhatsApp capture	✗ Partial only	✗ None	✗ None	✗ None
No mobile app	✗ Missing	⚠ Basic only	✗ Missing	✓ Yes
Manual data entry still required	⚠ Partial	⚠ High config tax	⚠ Partial	✗ Heavy
Reporting too basic at scale	✗ Beta	⚠ Improving	✗ Weak	✗ Shallow
No call/phone intelligence	✗ None	✗ Regressed	✗ None	✗ Manual
Email visible but not contextual	⚠ Partial	✓ Better	⚠ One-way	⚠ Partial
Pricing punishes growth	⚠ Medium	⚠ Medium	⚠ Low	✗ High

02. The User

Primary Persona: The Founder-Seller

Source: Founder Persona document

Attribute	Detail
Company stage	0-5 person startup, founder selling personally
Daily reality	Context-switches 8-12 times daily across product, hiring, investors, and sales
Communication channels	WhatsApp, LinkedIn DMs, Gmail, phone calls, Slack
Tracking method	Notion, Google Sheets, Airtable, starred emails, memory
Goal	Close deals and build enough relationship context to hand off to first hire
Behaviour	Skips CRM logging because cost (3-5 min) exceeds perceived benefit. Operates memory-driven.
Mental model	"I know where things are in my head. Until I don't."

Global Founder market

150M+ Startups worldwide <i>Active registered globally</i>	\$285B VC invested in 2024 <i>Global venture capital deployed</i>	90% Fail within 10 years <i>Most within the first 3</i>	1 in 12 Startups become unicorns <i>Valued at \$1B+ at some point</i>	4.4M New US companies/year <i>Fastest pace on record (2023)</i>
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FUNDING LANDSCAPE

Stage	Median Round	Median Valuation
Pre-Seed	\$500K	\$4M
Seed	\$3M	\$12M
Series A	\$12M	\$45M
Series B	\$30M	\$140M
Series C+	\$60M+	\$400M+

Source: Carta State of Private Markets 2024

FOUNDER PROFILE

At founding	Share of founders
Solo founder (1 person)	23%
2 co-founders	52%
3 co-founders	18%
4+ co-founders	7%

Fact	Number
Avg founder age at start	34 years
First-time founders	72%
Previously exited	14%
From Big Tech (FAANG)	22%

Source: First Round · Crunchbase · Stripe Atlas 2024

WHY STARTUPS FAIL

Reason	Startups affected
No market need	42%
Ran out of cash	29%
Wrong team	23%
Too much competition	19%
Pricing / cost issues	18%
Poor product	17%
Ignoring customers	14%

Source: CB Insights 2024 · companies can cite multiple reasons

\$3.4T Total global startup ecosystem value <i>Startup Genome 2024</i>	137M Entrepreneurs active worldwide <i>GEM Global Report 2024</i>	17% Of US GDP generated by startups < 5 yrs old <i>Kauffman Foundation</i>	56% Of US unicorns founded by immigrants <i>NFAP 2024</i>	\$1.3M Median Series A valuation per employee <i>Carta 2024</i>
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Sources: CB Insights 2024 · Carta State of Private Markets 2024 · Startup Genome 2024 · Kauffman Foundation · GEM Global Report 2024 · Crunchbase 2024 · NFAP 2024 · First Round Capital · Stripe Atlas

Target Market

Dimension	Detail
ICP	Founder-led SaaS, \$100K-\$5M ARR, 0-5 employees
Primary market	English-speaking markets: US, UK, India, ANZ. Starting with the US and India given YC and Indie Hackers GTM.
TAM	\$50B+ (10,000+ founder-led startups in addressable market, \$200K avg deal size, \$1.8M annual loss per founder)
GTM entry	Y Combinator community, Product Hunt, Indie Hackers, direct outreach
Positioning	"The CRM that does not ask you to log anything."

03. Business Impact

Financial Consequences of Inaction

Scenario	Assumption	Outcome
Per founder -- status quo	15 active deals x \$200K avg x 60% never followed up	\$1.8M revenue left on the table annually
Per founder -- with Relay	Follow-up gap closes from 60% to 20% (3x improvement)	\$1.2M recovered. \$600K net remaining gap.
100-founder cohort, Year 1	Conservative adoption, 3x follow-up improvement	\$120M in pipeline recovery across cohort
First hire failure reduction	91% to 70% failure rate via better context transfer	\$382M in hiring productivity recovered market-wide

Relay does not need to close every deal. It needs to stop deals from dying silently -- the \$1.8M problem that every founder has but no tool has solved.

Why This Is P0

Dimension	Score
Frequency	100% -- every founder-led startup experiences this
Severity	High -- \$10K to \$500K per missed follow-up
Strategic importance	Critical -- founder-to-team transition inflection point
Market timing	Optimal -- record founder-led SaaS growth
Competitive opportunity	Clear -- zero purpose-built solution exists

04. Prioritised Pain Points

Ranked by causal primacy, direct revenue impact, and phase prevalence -- applied in that order.

Rank	Pain Point	Why It Matters
1	Follow-Up Failure	80% of leads never followed up. 92% of salespeople stop at 4 attempts. 80% of deals close after 5-12 touches.
2	Manual CRM Entry Friction	32% of reps spend over 1 hr/day on manual entry. 73% say record updates take too much time.
3	Conversation Context Loss	Rich signals (objections, budget timing, competitor mentions) compress into "Good call."
4	Founder Context-Switching Overload	CRM logging is always lowest-priority. CEOs spend only 3% of time with customers.
5	No Sales Process Exists	73% lack documented scripts. 82% rely on referrals. Product cannot assume a process.
6	Channel Fragmentation	CRM has full access to coldest channel (email) and zero access to warmest (WhatsApp, calls).
7	Phantom Pipeline	Stages set manually and optimistically. No mechanism to flag cold deals.
8	First Sales Hire Failure	91% miss quota. 68% leave within 18 months. Empty CRM, no playbook, no context.
9	Founder Knowledge Locked in Head	Who is warm, what was promised, which competitor -- all in memory, none in a system.

05. The Six Named Failure Modes

Failure Mode	What Happens	Field Evidence
01. Context Collapse	Each channel stores conversations in isolation. Works at 20 deals. Fails completely at 80-150.	"They mentioned budget approval in a WhatsApp voice note. My CRM has no idea."
02. Manual Entry Bottleneck	Every data point requires a human decision to log. CRM updates are the first thing dropped under pressure.	"I only update the CRM on Fridays. By then half the context is gone."
03. Commitment Amnesia	Specific next-step commitments made in conversation are verbal. No CRM captures them automatically.	"The deal went cold because I forgot they said to call back after their board meeting."
04. Phantom Pipeline	Deal stages set manually and optimistically. No mechanism to flag that a deal has gone dark.	"14 deals in Proposal Sent for three months. Actual closes: 2."

Failure Mode	What Happens	Field Evidence
05. Signal Without Intelligence	CRM records activity but not intent. A fast enthusiastic reply and a slow one-word reply look identical.	"My CRM said both deals were at the same stage. One closed. One ghosted."
06. The Scaling Cliff	Manual model barely works at 20-30 deals. At 80-150, when the first hire joins, it breaks entirely.	"I spent two weeks briefing my first hire on every deal. None of it was in the CRM."

06. Channel Access Constraints

Channel	Warmth	API Access	Reality
Email (Gmail/Outlook)	Medium	Full OAuth	Fully capturable. But the coldest conversations.
Calendar (Google/Outlook)	Low-Med	Full API	Metadata capturable. Not content.
Zoom / Meet	High	Partial (bot join)	Transcript capturable with bot. Not spontaneous calls.
Mobile Calls	High	None. Carrier-level.	Architecturally invisible. No API exists.
WhatsApp (Personal)	Very High	None. E2E encrypted.	The warmest channel is completely closed. [adiint]
LinkedIn DMs	High	Deliberately locked by Microsoft	First-touch context invisible. [adiint]

07. The Founder Tool Stack

The real competition is not Salesforce or HubSpot. It is the workaround stack founders build when every CRM has let them down.

Workaround	What It Replaces	Why It Is Trusted
Notion board	CRM and pipeline	Flexible, visual, spent weeks building it. [21]
Airtable + linked databases	Relationship tracker	Configurable without code. [21]
Google Sheets	Lead tracker	Familiar, shareable, free.
Starred emails	Pipeline priority system	Already open all day.
WhatsApp thread to self	Client log	Where conversations already live.

Workaround	What It Replaces	Why It Is Trusted
Sticky notes / memory	Follow-up system	Zero friction, zero setup.

7 Insights

Where the existing CRM model fails founders

#	Insight	What it means	Design implication	Breaks at
1	CRMs capture memory, not reality	By the time a founder logs a deal, they're reconstructing what happened; not recording it. Every forecast and handoff is built on a faded memory.	<i>Capture at the moment it happens, not after.</i>	At logging
2	CRMs punish your best salespeople most	Records are fullest when deals are slow and emptiest when the pipeline is on fire. Investors see the most incomplete data exactly when things are going best.	<i>The system must auto-capture more as deal velocity increases, not less.</i>	At peak activity
3	Full access to cold channels, zero access to warm ones	CRMs connect easily to email, the most formal, lowest-trust channel. They're blind to WhatsApp and LinkedIn DMs, where real trust is built and real decisions are made.	<i>Any integration-based tool will always be blind to the strongest signals.</i>	At channel layer
4	Pipeline stages are opinions, not facts	When a founder marks a deal "Negotiation," they're expressing how they feel about it that day not reporting a verified fact. AI trained on this learns to predict from other predictions.	<i>Replace declared stages with behavioural signals: response time, meeting frequency, silence gaps.</i>	At pipeline view
5	The handoff is an information collapse	The founder holds a mental model of each prospect: real objection vs. stated one, which channel works, who the internal champion is. None of that lives in a CRM field.	<i>The product needs to transfer the founder's mental model not just log what happened.</i>	At team handoff
6	No tool captures commitments	"Call me after the board meeting on the 20th" is the highest-signal moment in any deal. It lives in a call or a WhatsApp and disappears before the CRM is ever opened.	<i>Commitment extraction needs to be its own product category automatic, not manual.</i>	During conversation
7	Activity metrics lie at founder scale	40 emails with someone who won't buy looks like a hot deal. Two WhatsApp messages with real buying intent are invisible. CRMs mistake volume of communication for quality of it.	<i>Deal health needs a new signal model: channel type, response latency, conversational trajectory.</i>	At intelligence layer

08. The Solution

Design Philosophy

Intercept conversations already happening and extract intelligence without asking the founder to type anything.

The Opportunity

1. Existing CRMs are failing because they require setup, upkeep, and behavior change before they provide value.
2. Founder-led sales is the default growth model for many startups through the first phase of scale. That makes this a large and repeated problem.
3. Teams are staying leaner for longer, founders are expected to manage more functions at once, and the gap between how founders actually sell and how CRMs expect them to work is becoming more visible

Before Relay vs. With Relay

Situation	Before Relay	With Relay
Post-call	The founder tries to log. Gets distracted. Logs nothing or "Good call."	Calendar detects meeting end. LLM drafts follow-up. Founder taps send. That sent email becomes the call record.
Morning routine	Open inbox. Tries to remember who needs follow-up. Misses 60-80%.	Digest in inbox: "3 drafts ready. 5 follow-ups. Priya went quiet 14 days ago."
Before a meeting	Searches email and Notion for context. It takes 10 min.	Pre-call brief auto-generated from thread + calendar + tracker notes. Surfaced automatically.
First hire onboarding	2 weeks of verbal briefings. Empty CRM.	Hire reads Relay record. Full deal context, warmth scores, history. Starts contributing in under 30 min.
On-demand query	Searches across Notion, email, WhatsApp. Takes 5+ min.	"What's Priya's status?" returns reconstructed answer in 3 seconds.

Why This Approach

System	Effort per Interaction	Adoption	Accuracy
Traditional CRM	5 min manual entry	20-40%	High
Relay	0 min passive	80%+	Medium-High

When behavioural tax is near-zero, adoption is high. This is the moat: economic, not technical. Competitors cannot match it without rethinking their entire architecture.

Three Core Outputs

Output A: Auto-Records

Deal records populate automatically from:

- Email ingestion (Nylas): Nylas is a third-party API that normalises Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail, Yahoo, and Hotmail into a single integration. Signals captured: response latency, silence gaps (days since last contact), thread velocity, starred status.
- Calendar ingestion (Cronofy): Cronofy is a third-party API covering Google Calendar, Outlook, Apple Calendar, and Exchange. Signals captured: meeting frequency, duration, reschedule count, no-show flags. Calendly and Cal.com webhooks added separately for scheduling-link calls.
- Tracker import (Notion, Sheets, Airtable): Ingested on day one from the founder's existing tracker. Provides pre-seeded contact list, historical notes, and founder-stated deal stages.

Produces: Warmth score per deal (Hot / Warm / Cooling / Cold)

Output B: Proactive Nudges

Morning email digest delivered to the founder's existing inbox. No new app to check.

Digest Item	What It Shows
Follow-ups	Who went silent, for how long, and why it matters
Drafts ready	Auto-generated follow-up from pre-call email thread context
Upcoming	Pre-call brief with inferred context from email and notes
Off Track	Stage mismatches where tracker says X but signals say Y

Output C: On-Demand Retrieval

Founder types: "What's Priya's status?" or "What did we discuss about pricing?"

Relay returns: Reconstructed meaning inferred from email thread, calendar, and notes. All inferred content is labelled as such with a confidence indicator.

09. How It Works

Data Layer

Must	What It Does	Technical Approach	Why It Is Non-Negotiable
Must 1: Email Ingestion	Captures thread history, response latency, silence gaps, thread velocity, starred status	Nylas API. 6-month retroactive ingestion on day one.	Foundation for all signals. Without it, no warmth scoring is possible.
Must 2: Calendar Ingestion	Captures meeting history, frequency, duration, reschedule count, no-shows. Acts as the automation trigger layer.	Cronofy + Calendly/Cal.com webhooks. 6-month retroactive.	Calendar is the only layer that knows in real time when a call ends. Every post-call automation depends on it.
Must 3: Tracker Import	Ingests founder's Notion, Sheets, or Airtable on day one. Seeds known contacts, historical notes, and deal stages.	Notion API, Google Sheets API, Airtable API, CSV fallback.	Solves cold start. Without it, the product is blank on day one and founders abandon it within 3 days.

Write-back is non-negotiable. Without it, two sources of truth emerge and the founder abandons the product. Relay writes back append-only, with a preview before first write, one-tap approval for stage changes, and a full audit log. The founder's existing Notion or Sheets record gets smarter. Relay does not compete with it.

Intelligence Layer

Must	What It Does	How the AI Works
Must 4: Behavioural Signal Engine	Computes warmth score per deal from email and calendar metadata. Hot / Warm / Cooling / Cold.	Warmth score = weighted combination of: silence gap (days since last contact), thread velocity (messages per week), response latency ratio (their response time vs. baseline), reschedule count, and meeting frequency trend. No email body content is read. Metadata only.
Must 5: Auto-Draft Follow-Up	Calendar detects meeting end. LLM drafts a follow-up email. Push notification fires. Founder taps send.	LLM uses: pre-call email thread (last 3-5 messages), calendar event metadata (attendees, duration, title), founder's Notion notes on the deal. Draft is presented for one-tap approval. The sent email becomes the call record -- Relay reads it back.
Must 6: Context Reconstruction	Infers probable call content from surrounding signals. Flagged as [Inferred -- not recorded] with confidence score.	LLM analyses: pre-call email thread, post-call emails, Notion notes, calendar metadata. Confidence tiers: 85%+ auto-display / 50-85% display with confirm prompt / below 50% explicit ask. Delivers ~80% of transcript value for 0% recording friction.

Stage Model

Stage	Auto-Inferred When	Cooling Threshold	Cold Threshold
On Radar	Email thread exists, no meeting detected	14 days	30 days
In Conversation	Meeting detected OR thread velocity >1/week	7 days	21 days
Qualified	LLM detects BANT signal in emails or tracker notes	5 days	14 days
Proposal Out	Outbound attachment sent, no counter received	7 days	21 days
Closing	Pricing/terms language detected post-proposal	3 days	7 days
Closed Won	Manual only. Never auto-inferred.	--	--
Closed Lost	Manual only. Never auto-inferred.	--	--

Working prototypes

Link - https://Rahul2R.github.io/Relay_V1

Screenshots -

Relay

Step 1 of 6 Skip this step

WELCOME TO RELAY

Your deals, *remembered.*

Relay sits on top of the tools you already use and tells you exactly who to follow up with — without you logging a single thing. Let's set you up in under 5 minutes.

YOUR NAME

e.g. Arjun

YOUR COMPANY

e.g. Kaleidoscope Labs

Get started →

STEP 3 OF 6 — OPTIONAL BUT VALUABLE

Connect your *deal tracker*

Your Notion, Sheets, or Airtable is your current CRM. Relay reads it to know who you're already tracking — so day one isn't empty. We'll write back to it too, so it stays updated automatically.

**Notion**

Database pages + free-form pipeline docs

Optional

Connect

**Google Sheets**

Lead lists, deal trackers, any spreadsheet pipeline

Optional

Connect

**Airtable**

Base import — most structured data quality

Optional

Connect

**CSV Upload**

Export from anywhere and drop it in

Optional

Upload

Continue →

[Skip for now](#)

STEP 4 OF 6 — READING YOUR HISTORY

Building your *baseline*

Relay is reading 6 months of email and calendar history. This is what normally takes 2 weeks — done in minutes.

	Email threads	847 threads
	Calendar meetings	38 meetings
	Notion contacts	22 contacts
	Scoring warmth	18 scored
	Identifying prospects	18 prospects

QUICK CLASSIFY — WHO ARE YOUR PROSPECTS?

PS	Priya Sharma Acme Corp · 8 emails · last: 4 days ago	Prospect ✓	Not a prospect
MR	Marcus Rodriguez TechCorp · 12 emails · meeting tomorrow	Prospect ✓	Not a prospect
JL	James Liu FinStack · 5 emails · last: 2 days ago	Prospect ✓	Not a prospect

Looks good — continue →

[Skip classification](#)

Relay

Step 5 of 6Skip this step

STEP 5 OF 6 - ONE-TIME MAPPING

Map your *Notion* columns

Relay found your pipeline database. It mapped most columns automatically. Confirm the ones it's confident about and clarify the ones it's unsure of.

✓

Contact name

95% confident

Notion: "Name" → Relay: Contact name

✓

Company

91% confident

Notion: "Company" → Relay: Company name

?

Deal stage

67% confident

Notion: "Status" → Relay: Deal stage

Looks right ✓Change mapping

?

Deal notes

58% confident

Notion: "Notes" → Relay: Activity notes

Looks right ✓Change mapping

All good — take me in →

Save and finish later

Relay

Tuesday, 11 March 2026

WORKSPACE

Today

8

Pipeline

Pending

4

RECENT CONTACTS

PS

Priya Sharma

!

MR

Marcus Rodriguez

JL

James Liu

SK

Sneha Kapoor

Setup progress

Add sources

2 of 3 sources connected

Email digest

SMS retrieval

Mobile capture

Settings

From relay@relay.app

3 drafts ready · 5 follow-ups · Tue 11 Mar

Tuesday, 11 March 2026 · 7:00 AM

Good morning, Arjun.

Here's what needs your attention today. Low-stakes actions can be taken directly from this email — anything that needs context links to the app.

DRAFTS READY — REVIEW & SEND

Marcus Rodriguez · TechCorp

Draft ready

Post-call follow-up from your meeting earlier. Covers API docs + co-founder intro on 24 Mar.

View & Send → Snooze 2h

Sneha Kapoor · BuildFast

Draft ready

Post-meeting follow-up from yesterday's 31-min call.

View & Send → Snooze

FOLLOW-UPS DUE

Priya Sharma · Acme Corp

18 days silent

No reply after pricing call. Proposal opened 3x. Stage mismatch flagged.

Compose → Snooze 3d Not needed

James Liu · FinStack

Replied yesterday

Positive tone. Momentum accelerating. Reply when ready.

Reply → Snooze

UPCOMING TODAY

Marcus Rodriguez · 2:00 PM

Pre-call brief

SCREENS

Today

Contact record

Pending queue

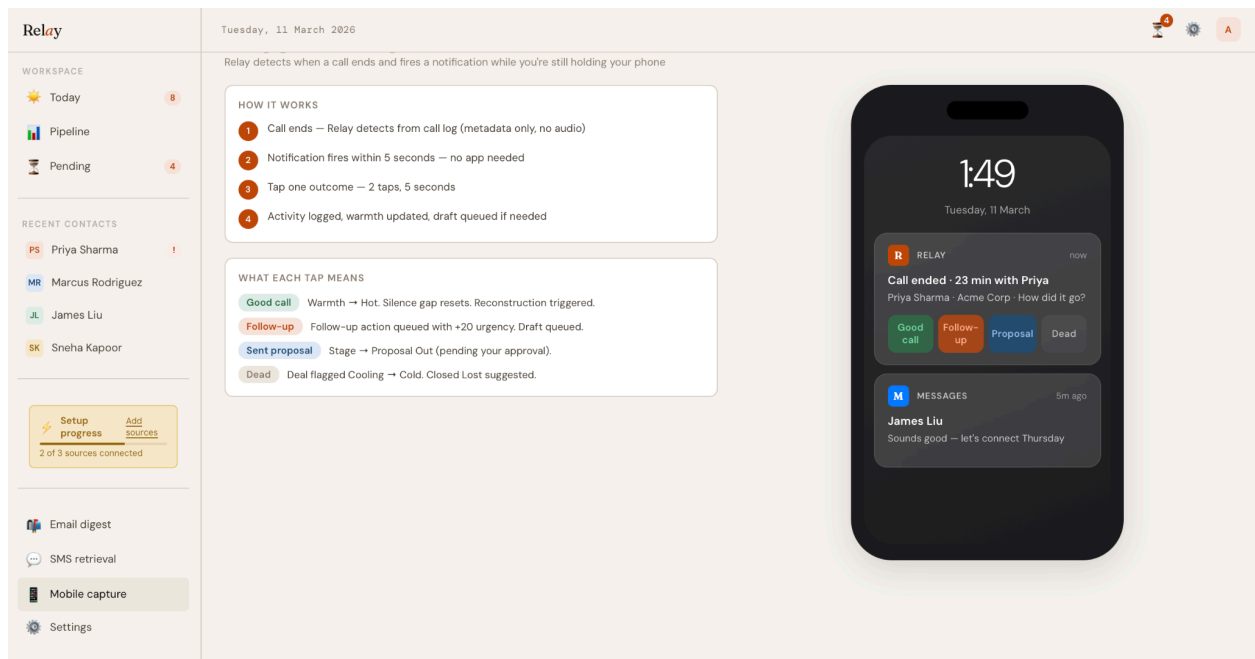
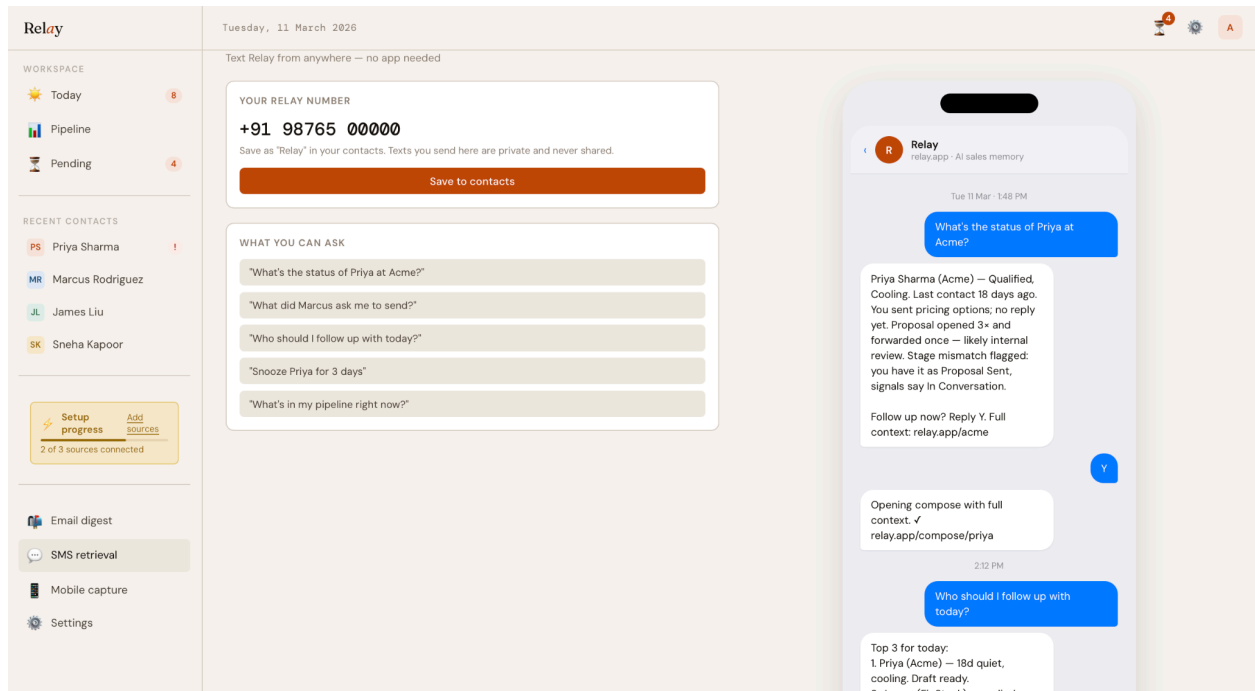
Pipeline

Email digest

SMS retrieval

Mobile capture

Settings



10. Out of Scope

MVP Ships

- ✓ Email ingestion (Nylas) + 6-month retroactive history
- ✓ Calendar ingestion (Cronofy + webhooks) + 6-month retroactive
- ✓ Tracker import (Notion / Sheets / Airtable / CSV)

- ✓ Behavioural signal engine (warmth scoring)
- ✓ Context reconstruction (LLM-inferred, flagged)
- ✓ Today view (unified urgency-ranked list)
- ✓ Contact record (history + on-demand query)
- ✓ Pending queue (write-back approvals)
- ✓ Morning email digest (async, no app habit required)
- ✓ Onboarding (email hard gate, calendar + tracker guided optional)
- ✓ Write-back (append-only, founder-approved, audit log)

Not in MVP

- ✗ 2-tap post-call mobile capture (Stage 3 -- requires iOS CallKit / Android READ_CALL_LOG)
- ✗ Platform-agnostic transcript pipeline (Stage 3 -- Meet, Zoom, Fathom, Fireflies, Otter)
- ✗ Pre-call consent + recording via Recall.ai (Stage 4 -- legal complexity)
- ✗ LinkedIn + WhatsApp browser extension (Stage 4 -- highest build complexity, most restricted APIs)
- ✗ SMS on-demand retrieval via Twilio (Stage 4 -- post-MVP mobile access layer)
- ✗ Auto-draft without reconstruction (accuracy concern without call content)
- ✗ Mobile app (needed for 2-tap capture; MVP is web desktop only)

Build Sequencing

Phase	Scope	Dependency
MVP: All 6 Musts	Email ingestion, calendar ingestion, tracker import, behavioural signals, auto-draft, context reconstruction	All 6 ship together. Data layer and intelligence layer are inseparable.
Stage 3	Platform-agnostic transcript pipeline, 2-tap post-call mobile capture, prospect signals	After core Musts are validated and stable.
Stage 4	Pre-call consent + recording via Recall.ai, LinkedIn + WhatsApp browser extension	Ships last. Highest legal and technical complexity.

11. Success Metrics

Relay is working best when the founder barely opens the app. High session time is a warning sign. Measure actions completed and drafts sent -- not logins.

North Star: Follow-Up Rate. % of active deals that received a follow-up within 7 days of last contact.
Target: 85%+. Before Relay: ~20%.

Question	Metric	Baseline	Target
Is Relay seeing enough?	Deals visible in Relay by end of week 1	--	80% of active pipeline
Is Relay seeing enough?	Contacts seeded on day one (before manual input)	0	15+ contacts
Is it accurate?	Warmth score agreement -- founder agrees with deal score	--	75% by week 4
Is it accurate?	Write-back approval rate -- accepted without editing	--	80%
Is the founder acting?	Draft acceptance -- sent without edits	--	65% by week 4
Is the founder acting?	Morning digest open rate	--	75%
Is the founder sticking?	Active at day 30 -- action taken in week 4	--	60%
Is the founder sticking?	Time to first value -- connection to first draft sent	--	Under 30 minutes

Do not measure: daily active users, time in app, contacts logged. These go up when Relay is creating work for the founder, not reducing it.

12. Engineering Feasibility

Technical Stack

Component	Service	Pricing	Status	Risk
Email ingestion	Nylas	Paid. Free tier for dev. \$0.004/email event at scale. ~\$200-400/mo at 1,000 users.	Proven. Used by thousands of products.	Low
Calendar ingestion	Cronofy	Paid. Starter ~\$99/mo. Enterprise pricing available.	Stable, documented.	Low
LLM inference	Claude API (Anthropic)	Paid. ~\$3/M input tokens, \$15/M output. Estimated \$0.05-0.15/user/day at MVP volume.	Available, cost-effective.	Low
Tracker import	Notion API, Google Sheets API, Airtable API	All free for API access at MVP volume.	Public, documented.	Low
Email digest delivery	SendGrid	Free tier up to 100/day. \$19.95/mo for up to 50K/mo.	Proven.	Low
Scheduling webhooks	Calendly / Cal.com webhooks	Free on most plans.	Documented.	Low

Critical path: 10-12 weeks for MVP. No hard blockers identified. All six Musts must ship together -- they are genuinely interdependent.

13. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Low adoption	Medium	Onboarding under 5 minutes. Cold start solved via day-one tracker ingestion. Async digest means no new app habit required.
LLM accuracy	Medium	All inferred content flagged clearly as [Inferred -- not recorded]. Confidence tiers displayed. Founder can edit inline. Calibration improves over time.
Privacy concerns	Medium	Metadata only -- no email body reading. Clear privacy communications. Full audit log. Founder controls all write-backs.
Competitive response	High	Moat is behavioural design economics, not features. Competitors cannot copy it without redesigning their entire architecture.
AI accuracy correction model	Not started	OPEN GAP. Critical for trust. Needs a dedicated design session.
Privacy / data trust narrative	Not started	OPEN GAP. Founders must hand over full email access. Narrative needed before public launch.
Team handoff design	Not started	OPEN GAP. How does a first hire inherit Relay? Needs specification.

14. Open Decisions

Decision	Options	Current Leaning
Notion mapping UX	All contacts at once (efficient, potentially overwhelming) vs one at a time (focused, slower)	OPEN -- resume at next design session
Write-back opt-in sequencing in onboarding	Before mapping? After first draft? Separate screen?	NOT DESIGNED -- critical for trust
Draft object schema	6th data model object needed for auto-draft lifecycle	PARKED
Urgency score formula weights	Silence gap days + warmth decay + stage criticality + missed commitments	PARKED
Pricing model	Freemium / per-seat / per-contact / usage-based	NOT STARTED

Decision	Options	Current Leaning
Mobile strategy	iOS + Android day one vs. Android-only MVP	NOT DECIDED

15. Strategic Alignment and Moat

Market Position

Dimension	Detail
TAM	\$50B+ (10,000+ founder-led startups in addressable market)
ICP	Founder-led SaaS, \$100K-\$5M ARR, 0-5 employees
GTM	Y Combinator, Product Hunt, Indie Hackers, direct outreach
Positioning	"The CRM that does not ask you to log anything."

The Moat

The moat is not technical. Features can be copied. The moat is economic: when behavioural tax is zero, adoption is high. Traditional CRMs charge a behavioural tax. Relay charges near-zero. Competitors cannot match this without redesigning their entire architecture and abandoning their existing product philosophy.

Long-Term Vision

Horizon	What Relay Becomes	Why It Matters
Year 1 (MVP)	The CRM that does not ask you to log anything. Follow-up engine. Context layer.	Solves the \$1.8M/founder problem. Proves the passive capture model works.
Year 2 (Platform)	Relay expands beyond sales: investor updates, hiring conversations, partnership deals.	Every founder conversation has the same problem. The moat deepens as the relationship graph grows.
Year 3 (Intelligence)	Relay knows the patterns of deals that close vs. die. Surfaces: "Deals like this close after 3 touches in 14 days -- you're on touch 2, day 11."	Collective intelligence across the founder base. Each new user makes the model smarter.

Appendix: Source Documents

Document	Type	Key Output
Discovery_Document.docx	Full research synthesis	12-source problem validation, statistics, ranked pain points, competitive landscape
Founder_Persona.docx	Primary persona	Arjun Dev full behavioural profile, daily workflow, anti-goals, design implications
Relay Glossary	Glossary	Explains different terms used in the document